



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE

Information and Communication Technology Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

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1.0 Introduction

New and emerging information and communication technology (ICT) increasingly play a crucial role in operations of the Jamaica Constabulary Force (JCF), equipping members with operational, investigative and administrative tools that have the potential of making them safer, better informed, and more effective and efficient. Developing and enforcing comprehensive organizational policies regarding ICT is a critical step in realizing the value that technologies promise, and is essential in assuring the public that their privacy and civil liberties are recognized and protected.

With technological advancements come new opportunities to enhance public and officer safety. They also present new challenges for law enforcement executives. The challenges include identifying which technologies can be incorporated by the agency to achieve the greatest public safety benefits, and defining metrics that will enable the JCF to monitor and assess the value and performance of the technologies.

There are also challenges in integrating these technologies across different platforms, building resilient infrastructure and comprehensive security, providing technical support, and maintaining and upgrading applications and hardware. All of this can be confusing and technically demanding, underscoring the need for effective policy guidelines on ICT. This ICT policy and procedures is in alignment with the Government of Jamaica ICT Policy and is developed in support of the JCF’s strategic approach to incorporate technology in its operations.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to provide guidelines for the proper use of the JCF’s information and communication technology resources, including computers, electronic devices, hardware, software and systems.

It is also to outline the force’s overarching policy on the security of information assets to ensure that the reputation and security of the force is upheld.

3.0 Scope

This ICT Policy and Standard Operating Procedures applies to all sworn and unsworn members of the JCF, its auxiliary contractors, subcontractors, and consultants, who have access to the JCF network, ICT equipment and or force information systems.

It covers all computer equipment, telephony, networks, and radio equipment of whatever description owned or operated by the Jamaica Constabulary Force.

4.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

- ICT - Information and Communication Technology
- ISP - Internet Service Providers

5.0 Definitions

For the purpose of this policy and standard operating procedures the following shall be adopted:

Communications system –The collection of individual telecommunications networks, transmission systems, relay stations, tributary stations, and terminal equipment capable of interconnection and interoperation.

Computer system - All computers (on-site and portable), electronic devices, hardware, software, and resources owned, leased, rented or licensed by the JCF that are provided for official use by its members. This includes all access to, and use of, Internet Service Providers (ISP) or other service providers provided by or through the Department or department funding.

Hardware - Includes, but is not limited to, computers, computer terminals, network equipment, electronic devices, telephones, including cellular and satellite, pagers, modems or any other tangible computer device generally understood to comprise hardware.

Software - Includes, but is not limited to, all computer programs, systems and applications, including shareware. This does not include files created by the individual user.

Temporary file, permanent file or file - Any electronic document, information or data residing or located, in whole or in part, on the system including, but not limited to, spreadsheets, calendar entries, appointments, tasks, notes, letters, reports, messages, photographs or videos.

6.0 Responsibilities

We need to determine a few for key Formation managers/supervisors and ICT Staff

7.0 Policy Statement

It is the policy of the JCF that members shall use information technology resources, including computers, software and systems, that are issued or maintained by the Department in a professional manner and in accordance with this policy.

7.1 Privacy Expectation

- 7.1.1 Members forfeit any expectation of privacy with regard to emails, texts or anything published, shared, transmitted or maintained through file-sharing software or any Internet site that is accessed, transmitted, received or reviewed on any department computer system.
- 7.1.2 The JCF reserves the right to access, audit and disclose, for whatever reason, any message, including attachments, and any information accessed, transmitted, received or reviewed over any technology that is issued or maintained by the Force, including the department email system, communication system, computer network and/or any information placed into storage on any department system or device.
- 7.1.3 However, the department may not require a member to disclose a personal username or password or open a personal social website, except when access is reasonably believed to be relevant to the investigation of allegations of work-related misconduct.

8.0 Standard Operating Procedures

- 8.1 All JCF information systems must be formally security-accredited by the Technology Branch and operated in accordance with approved policies and operating procedures. Newly acquired systems or databases for processing personal data must comply with JCF policy and be approved by the Technology Branch.
- 8.2 JCF business must only be conducted on equipment that is formally authorized by the Technology Branch (this includes associated software and databases).

8.3 Using Force information systems and technology

- a. Users must only access network facilities and services for which they have been specifically authorized.
- b. Any attempt to access information for which a user has no 'need to know' could result in disciplinary and/or criminal proceedings.
- c. All force employees and contractors are personally responsible for ensuring that they have access to, fully understand and comply with, all relevant Force security policies and operating procedures before accessing Force information or systems.

8.4 Physical environment security

- a. Buildings used to store police information and systems must have a secure perimeter that does not permit easy break-in.
- b. Access to the site should be restricted to authorized personnel only and all entry and exit points appropriately secured.
- c. Authentication and access controls, such as keys, cards and PINs, should be kept securely and disclosed to authorize personnel only. Any loss or compromise must be reported immediately.
- d. All personnel are required to wear visible ID when on force premises. All personnel must return ID Cards/keys on the termination of their employment/contract or if taking a career break of longer than 6 months.
- e. To reduce the risks from overhearing, meetings should only take place in areas that meet the appropriate level of security for the information that is to be discussed. It is advisable that no recording or transmitting devices (e.g. mobile phones) are taken into meetings where information at CONFIDENTIAL level or above is to be discussed.
- f. The doors and windows of offices and rooms containing unsecured or particularly sensitive information and systems must be locked when unattended.
- g. Where an intruder alarm has been provided as required protection for a premises, this should be set before the property is left unattended.
- h. Documents and equipment should be positioned so as not to risk the overlooking of sensitive information by unauthorized personnel.
- i. Faulty equipment must be treated with the same level of security as operational equipment. Before replacing or disposing of data storage media, all information must be securely erased in accordance with force policy.

8.5 Working with partners and contractors

- a. Any exchange of information with another organization must be through a legal gateway and/or supported by a formal, documented Information Sharing Agreement (ISA) and describes procedures for ensuring that the information is protected at all times.
- b. Whilst on force premises, contractors must either be accompanied at all times or security vetted to the appropriate level.
- c. Arrangements involving third party access to force information, force information processing facilities or force premises must be supported by a formal, written agreement.

- d. Any outsourcing arrangement must be fully supported by a formal contract between both parties that meets legal requirements. This must define appropriate controls to protect the security of Force information assets, including the issue and return of information, information access controls, and the force's right to audit.

8.6 Compliance

- a. The force use of any proprietary products and material must comply with statutory, regulatory and contractual requirements at all times. Copies of licence agreements and proof of ownership must be maintained.
- b. Personal information must only be obtained and processed for specified, lawful purposes.
- c. Processing of Force information, particularly personal data, may be unlawful if not carried out under the conditions described in a system's accredited documentation.
- d. The Access to Information Act gives a general right of access to all types of recorded information held by public authorities, sets out exemptions from that right and places a number of obligations on public authorities.

8.7 Passwords

- a. Users must use their own, designated User ID for accessing JCF systems. Users are solely accountable for all actions performed under their User ID and the sharing of personal User IDs is not permitted.
- b. Users may be issued passwords (including smart cards and PIN numbers) for gaining access to JCF systems or equipment (issued passwords must be changed immediately by the user). The users are personally responsible for keeping their passwords, cards and pin numbers secure and must not disclose these to anyone.
- c. When creating new passwords, these should be a minimum of 8 characters in length and whilst they should be memorable, they should not comprise of dictionary words, or anything obvious – such as a name, date of birth, or any personally associated with user. They should also consist of at least one character and one number. Under no circumstances should the passwords be reused.
- d. If at any time the user loses their ID Card or feel that their password's secrecy may have been compromised, they should contact the Technology Branch or the local IT Security Officer immediately.
- e. Always logout or lock the password-protected screen saver before leaving equipment unattended.

8.8 E-mail

- a. E-mail is a tool for business communication. All force business e-mail must be conducted using the force's standard e-mail system to ensure consistent addressing, update-to-date virus scanning, the appending of the force legal disclaimer and the maintenance of an auditable record. Therefore, you must not send business messages from a private e-mail account (e.g. yourname@hotmail.com).
- b. Reasonable personal use of e-mail is permitted during breaks and out-of-hours – (see section D.11 Reasonable personal use).

- c. Using obscene, defamatory, or otherwise offensive material in an e-mail message is strictly prohibited. This includes any material that contravenes the force's policy on equality and diversity (for example, racist, ageist or sexist). You are reminded that emails are official documents, and you will be held personally responsible for any messages that you send. Only use text that you could personally justify if later read out in court.
- d. E-mails must not be addressed to all Force personnel without prior approval of the Commissioner. Messages addressed to a whole department or branch, must have prior approval of the Head of Department or Divisional Commander. (Note: force-wide ICT service messages may be sent by authorized staff within the Technology Branch.)
- e. As with any other force communication, e-mail may be monitored by the force at any time, with or without prior notification. Any e-mail sent or received through the force's e-mail system, whether of a business or personal nature, may be read by authorized personnel at any time. Information contained in such messages may be used to document misconduct or criminal activity and may be revealed. Consider also that even internal e-mails may get disclosed under the Access to Information Act.
- f. Internet e-mail is not a secure medium of communication and is only suitable for messages that do not contain protectively marked information. Encryption may be available to protect Internet messages in some circumstances, contact the Technology Branch for more information.

8.9 Removable media

- a. Removable media, by its very nature, is particularly vulnerable to unauthorized access. If you have been authorized to use removable media you must ensure that appropriate controls are in place to protect the information that it contains, from the point of extraction to the secure destruction or reuse of that media.
- b. Media containing Protectively Marked data must be marked and protected accordingly. (This must be to the highest protectively marking of all information stored on it.) Personal removable media must not be connected to Force equipment at any time or for any reason.
- c. Media that leaves the organization is particularly vulnerable and must be protected by encryption and/or kept physically secure at all times.
- d. Information must be securely erased from removable media or the media must be securely destroyed, at the earliest opportunity. Contact the IT Security Officer for advice.

8.10 Changes and disposals

- a. Never move any fixed IT equipment; The Technology Branch will do this for you. Apart from health and safety concerns, it is essential that the force Asset Register is kept up to date. The Divisional Commander/ Head of department is responsible for notifying the Technology Branch of any potential equipment moves or changes of custodianship in advance.
- b. Any disposal of equipment must be carried out safely by Technology Branch, who will ensure that all police data is securely removed.

8.11 Reasonable personal use

- a. Unless advised otherwise, reasonable personal use of force ICT is permitted during breaks and out-of-hours, provided that it does not violate this policy nor interfere with JCF business (specific restrictions may apply for certain equipment and systems).
- b. Access to police systems or data for personal use is not permitted.
- c. Furthermore, reasonable use does not include conducting outside business or furthering your own personal financial gain, including the selling of items. Messages about charitable fund-raising events are permitted.
- d. You also may not deliberately perform any acts which will seriously impact the operation of the force's systems or are wasteful of computing resources, including creating excess network traffic, or interfering with the operational readiness of any computer.
- e. Care must be taken to ensure that the receiver of a private message cannot mistake it for an official JCF business communication.
- f. Remember that the force reserves the right to monitor any and all communications using force equipment to ensure compliance with force policies and standards.

8.12 Incident reporting

Any actual or suspected security breaches, or even perceived weaknesses in information security, should be reported to the local IT Security Officer and/or the Technology Branch.

8.13 Personnel security

- a. Employees and contractors must be vetted to the necessary level.
- b. Contractors who are not accompanied whilst on force premises must be vetted to the appropriate level. Contractors who will have access to Force information systems, corporate databases, data networks or hard copy material (including remote access) must also be appropriately vetted.
- c. Employees and Contractors must sign a confidentiality agreement, either separately or as part of an associated contract before obtaining access to Force information.
- d. Before receiving access to Force information systems, all Employees and Contractors must meet any system-specific training requirements.
- e. All Employees and Contractors must report any security incidents, malfunctions or suspected security weaknesses, to the Force IT Security Officers.
- f. Any Employee who has reason to believe they have information pointing to 'wrongdoing', such as a criminal offence having been committed, should report the matter as soon as practicable.

8.14 Radio and Telephony

This section relates to the secure use of Force radios and telephones.

- a. Members must be aware that any police communications facility, such as radio, telephone or fax, could be intercepted by unauthorized persons; and always be alert to the possibility of being overheard and avoid disclosing sensitive information unless absolutely vital.

- b. Users of Force telecommunication systems must also be aware that conversations may be recorded and that all force information systems are the subject of regular audit.
- c. Police radio transmissions may be scanned or monitored by members of the public (which includes criminals). When passing messages and information over any radio system, keep the message as brief as possible and try to avoid sending anything sensitive or delicate (such as details of an offender's convictions) unless absolutely vital at that moment.
- d. Any person to whom radio equipment is issued will ensure that it is kept in their custody or securely stored at all times.
- e. Any person who damages, loses or is suspected to have lost their terminal will report it forthwith to a supervisor and the Duty Officer in the Force Communications Centre.
- f. All radio faults and poor coverage should be reported.
- g. No procurement of non-standard radio equipment or changes to the Forces radio system will be made other than through the Technology Branch.

8.15 Use of radio equipment

- a. It is incumbent upon every officer and police staff employee having charge of a radio or other radio equipment to treat such a valuable piece of equipment with the utmost care and to ensure its security at all times.
- b. Where radio equipment is lost or damaged the Area/Department will be responsible for any costs incurred.
- c. Police employees who are not based on police premises may be permitted to use the keep and care policy but this must be authorized by a senior officer/supervisor and notification forwarded to the Technology Branch.

8.16 Telephone communications

- a. Users must ensure that information is passed only to an authorized recipient. If in doubt, arrange to call back and make sure you are ringing an official police or approved external agency number first.
- b. It is better to speak face to face if the topic is sensitive. Telephones and other communication devices should not be taken into sensitive meetings.
- c. Sensitive information must not be discussed in places where there is a risk from being overheard, such as public places or open/insecure offices. This also applies to the recipient's situation.
- d. When discussing Force matters on the telephone, do not provide more information than is absolutely necessary and speak guardedly. Be aware of how much an operation can be compromised by giving too much detail.
- e. Sensitive information must never be left on answering machines, in case it gets replayed or overheard by an unauthorized person.

8.17 Audit

- a. Users must be aware that all force information systems are subject to regular audit by the Force Inspection Branch and/or the Technology Branch.
- b. Employees and contractors may be asked to explain why access, browsing, use or disclosure has taken place as part of normal supervisory as well as audit purposes. Compliance Audits will also assess the status and

operation of a system against Policy and operating procedures. System data will also be assessed.

- c. Supervisors are expected to ensure that users of information systems adhere to force policy.

9.0 Legislative Authority/Guiding Principles

- The Access to Information Act 2002
- Government of Jamaica Information and Communications Technology (ICT) Policy 2011
- ICT policies, standards & guidelines prepared by the office of the chief information officer – Jamaica February 2018

10.0 Relevant records and Forms

11.0 Roles and functions